

M-16 — What Never to Paste Into AI

What is this about?

The five red lines, the two-second test, and exactly what to type instead when you are in a hurry.

The idea, in plain terms

Farhan in accounts needs a payment-reminder letter. He pastes the customer ageing report — 340 names, phone numbers and outstanding amounts — into a free AI site. The letter that comes back is excellent. The report is now on a server we do not control. You will know in two seconds whether something is safe to paste — and exactly what to type instead.

Key things to know

- You signed in with a personal email rather than your work address.
- There is no company logo and no single sign-on screen.
- The site offered you a free trial, or asked for a card.
- You found it through a search result or a social media post.

A simple example

Situation: A tender response is due at 6. The approved assistant on your laptop is down. The tender document runs to 40 pages and you need the eligibility criteria summarised.

What to do: Read the eligibility section yourself — it is four pages out of forty.

Remember

- **Five things never go in** — Personal data, contract terms, financials, logins, anything marked confidential.
- **Facts, not files** — Describe the situation. Do not paste the document the situation came from.
- **Names come out first** — Names, numbers and addresses before anything else. Those are what regulators count.
- **Approval is more than an account** — The specific tool, account and use all need approval — not just a work login.
- **You cannot recall a paste** — No delete button reaches every copy. Prevention is the only control you have.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-16. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.